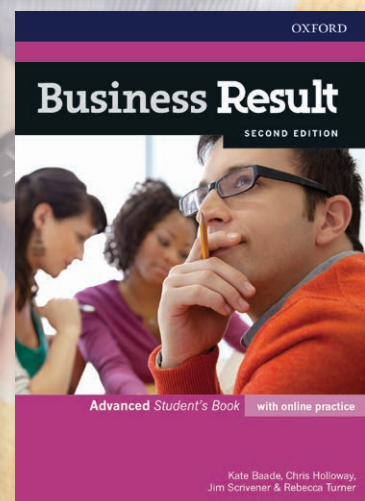
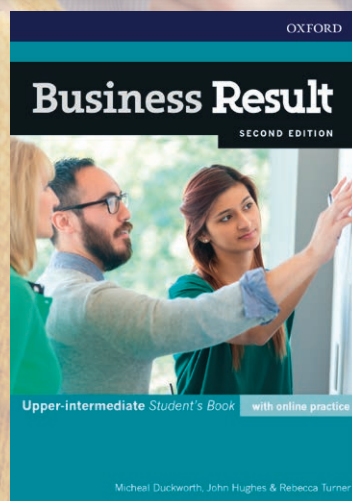
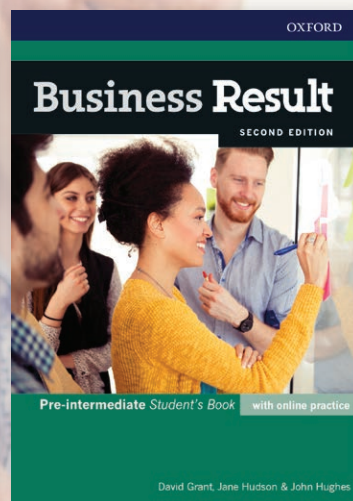
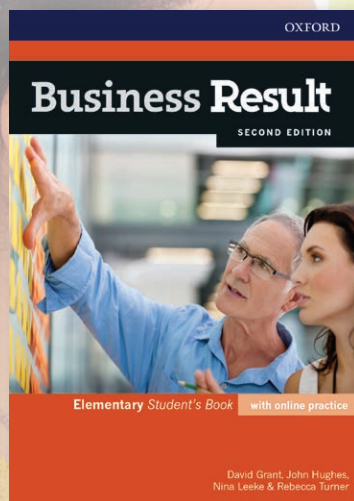
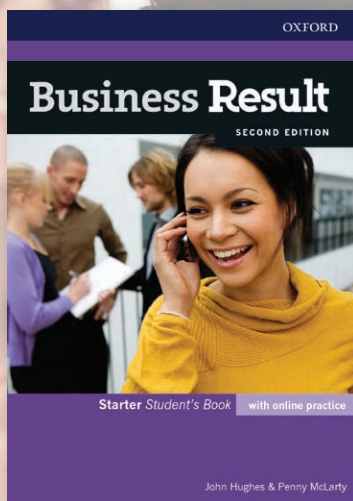


OXFORD

Business Result

SECOND EDITION



Intermediate *Student's Book*

SAMPLE PAGES

Contents

Introduction

4-5

1

Jobs

6-11

2

Products and services

12-17

3

Location

18-23

4

Technology

26-31

5

Communication

32-37

6

Networking

38-43

Working with words	Language at work	Practically speaking	Business communication	Talking point	Outcomes – you can
Countries, nationalities, jobs	Present simple Possessives	How to spell	Saying hello and goodbye	The introductions game	- say what you do and where you are from - ask about personal information - spell - say hello and goodbye and introduce yourself and others
Company types and activities	Present simple	How to say numbers	Making phone calls	Hungary: country profile	- talk about company types and activities - ask about companies - say numbers - start and end a phone call
Location and workplace	There <i>is/are</i> <i>Some/any</i>	Saying email and postal addresses	Ordering by phone	What is the best city for your conference?	- talk about your company location and buildings - ask for details about places - give addresses - order things by phone
Viewpoint 1  VIDEO Places of work 24-25					
Technology and functions	Adverbs of frequency Questions	How to use sequencing words	Asking for and offering help	Making use of technology	- talk about technology - talk about everyday activities - ask questions in the present simple - ask for and offer help
Documents and correspondence	Past simple: <i>be</i> and regular verbs	How to apologize	Solving problems	Money talks	- deal with documents - talk about past events - apologize - explain and solve a problem
Social media and networking	Past simple: irregular verbs Time expressions	How to describe a trip	Making conversation	The networking game	- talk about social media - use time expressions to talk about the past - describe a trip - make general conversation
Viewpoint 2  VIDEO You've got email 44-45					

		Working with words	Language at work	Practically speaking	Business communication	Talking point	Outcomes – you can
7	Departments 46–51	Departments and responsibilities	Prepositions of place and movement	How to use <i>this, that, these</i> and <i>those</i>	Leaving phone messages	Designing the perfect workspace	- describe departments and responsibilities - say where things are and give directions using prepositions - leave a phone message
8	Employment 52–57	Employment	Present continuous	How to tell the time	Arranging to meet	The right person for the job	- talk about professional qualities, skills and experience - talk about what you are doing now - tell the time - arrange a meeting
9	Competition 58–63	Competition	Comparatives	How to say prices	Comparing and choosing	Supermarket competition	- talk about competition - compare products and companies - say prices - talk about differences and similarities
Viewpoint 3 VIDEO Processes 64–65							
10	Teamwork 66–71	Working in teams	Superlatives	How to respond to news	Giving opinions	Teamwork and personality types	- talk about teamwork - choose the best options - respond to news - give opinions
11	Travel 72–77	Staying at a hotel	Going to Infinitive of purpose	How to talk about money	Eating out	More efficient business trips	- book a hotel room and ask about hotel services - talk about future plans - give reasons for actions - talk about money - order food in a restaurant
12	Schedules 78–83	Calendars and schedules	Present perfect	How to use prepositions of time	Planning a schedule	The revision game	- talk about schedules - talk about recent past actions - say when something happens - say dates - plan a schedule
Viewpoint 4 VIDEO A business trip 84–85							

Practice files 86–109

Communication activities 110–119

Audio scripts 120–126

Irregular verb list 127

Contents

Introduction

4-5

1 Companies

6-11

2 Contacts

12-17

3 Products and services

18-23

4 Visitors

26-31

5 Customer service

32-37

6 Employment

38-43

7 Travel

46-51

8 Orders

52-57

2

Working with words	Language at work	Practically speaking	Business communication	Talking point	Outcomes – you can
Company facts	Present simple	How to ask somebody to repeat information	Making introductions	Make that contact!	- talk about what companies do - talk about your company - ask somebody to repeat information - introduce yourself and others
Describing your job and contacts	Present continuous	How to say phone numbers and spell names	Making and receiving phone calls	Do you work too much?	- describe your job and the people you work with - talk about work activities - give phone numbers and spell names - make and receive phone calls
Describing products and services	Past simple	How to show interest	Giving a research report	Products you can't live without	- describe a company's products and services - talk about inventions - show interest in a conversation - give a research report
Viewpoint 1 VIDEO A company profile 24-25					
Company structure	Asking questions	How to confirm information	Welcoming a visitor	The question game	- talk about company structure - ask questions - confirm information - welcome a visitor
Customer service	Comparisons	How to 'soften' a message	Making and dealing with complaints	The WOW! Awards	- talk about customer service - make comparisons - soften a message when complaining - make and deal with complaints
Employment	Present perfect (1)	How to avoid negative answers	Evaluating options	The best companies to work for?	- talk about employment procedures - describe your experience in a job interview - turn a negative answer into a positive answer - evaluate options
Viewpoint 2 VIDEO The customer journey 44-45					
Air travel	will/going to/present continuous	How to ask for directions	Arranging to meet	The travel game	- talk about air travel - discuss future plans, arrangements and decisions - ask for and give directions - make arrangements to meet
Orders and deliveries	The passive	How to discuss payment terms	Making requests	Comparing payment methods	- talk about orders and deliveries - talk about order processes - discuss payment terms - make and respond to requests

		Working with words	Language at work	Practically speaking	Business communication	Talking point	Outcomes – you can
9	Selling 58–63	Advertising	Modal verbs (1) obligation, necessity and permission	How to interrupt and avoid interruption	Controlling the discussion in meetings	Going viral	• talk about advertising • talk about obligation, necessity and permission • interrupt and avoid being interrupted • control the discussion in meetings
		Viewpoint 3 VIDEO What colour is your logo? 64–65					
10	Teamwork 66–71	Environmental protection	First conditional	How to ask for clarification	Giving a formal presentation	Nudging	• talk about environmental protection • talk about probable future results • ask for clarification • give a formal presentation
11	Environment 72–77	Corporate hospitality	Countable and uncountable nouns	How to ask about food on a menu	Inviting and offering	Hospitality or bribery?	• talk about corporate hospitality • talk about corporate event facilities • ask about food on a menu • make invitations and offers
12	Performance 78–83	Evaluating performance	Present perfect (2) with <i>for</i> and <i>since</i>	How to say complex numbers	Describing trends	The performance game	• talk about performance • talk about how long and when you have done things • say complex numbers • describe performance trends
		Viewpoint 4 VIDEO Green business 84–85					
13	Future trends 86–91	Global issues	Future predictions	How to link ideas	Predicting and forecasting	Cause marketing	• talk about global issues • make predictions • link ideas together • make predictions and forecasts
14	Time 92–97	Managing time	Second conditional	How to use time expressions	Negotiating conditions	What happened to our free time?	• talk about time management • speculate and discuss consequences • talk about deadlines • negotiate conditions
15	Training 98–103	Personal development and training	Modal verbs (2) (giving advice)	How to give positive feedback	Making and responding to suggestions	Ambition!	• talk about personal development and training • give advice • give and respond to positive feedback • make and respond to suggestions
		Viewpoint 5 VIDEO A successful partnership 104–105					

Practice files **106–135**Audio scripts **148–158**Communication activities **136–147**Irregular verb list **159**

Contents

Introduction

4–5

1 Working life

6–11

2 Work-life balance

12–17

3 Projects

18–23

Working with words	Language at work	Practically speaking	Business communication	Talking point	Outcomes – you can
Describing work	Present simple and present continuous	How to show interest	Networking	Speed networking	- talk about yourself and your work - give a short personal presentation - show interest during conversations - network with groups of people
Work-life balance	to + infinitive and -ing form	How to say 'yes'	Exchanging contact details	Corridor conversations	- talk about work-life balance - say 'yes' in different ways - exchange contact details
Projects	Present perfect and past simple	How to give short answers	Updating and delegating tasks	Scenario planning	- talk about projects - talk about the progress of a project - give short answers - update and delegate tasks
Viewpoint 1  VIDEO Sharing a workspace 24–25					
Services and systems	Comparative forms and modifiers	How to be approximate	Explaining features and benefits	Stack ranking	- talk about services and systems - make comparisons - talk about approximate numbers - talk about features and benefits
Customer service	Present tenses for future reference	How to say 'sorry'	Making and changing arrangements	Upside down management	- talk about customer service - talk about schedules and future arrangements - say 'sorry' in different ways - make and change arrangements
Business travel	Articles	How to address people	Welcoming visitors	Cultural expectations	- talk about business travel schedules - use articles - find out how to address people - welcome visitors and talk about their journey
Viewpoint 2  VIDEO Cultural communication 44–45					
Online security	Obligation, prohibition and permission	How to sequence an explanation	Teleconferencing	Online, but are you working?	- talk about online security at work - talk about rules - explain clearly - take part in a teleconference
Finance and money	Talking about the future	How to use <i>will</i>	Presenting visual information	Investment opportunities	- talk about how to finance a new business idea - talk about future predictions - use <i>will</i> in different ways - give a presentation with visual information

2

		Working with words	Language at work	Practically speaking	Business communication	Talking point	Outcomes – you can
9	Logistics 58–63	Logistics and supply chains	Direct and indirect questions	How to use <i>say</i> and <i>tell</i>	Placing and handling orders	Shadow work	• talk about logistics and supply chains • ask direct and indirect questions • use <i>say</i> and <i>tell</i> correctly • place and handle orders
		Viewpoint 3 VIDEO Cybercrime 64–65					
10	Facilities 66–71	Describing a place of work	Quantifiers	How to use <i>too</i> and <i>enough</i>	Making suggestions and recommendations	The Hawthorne Effect	• describe a place of work and its facilities • use quantifiers • use <i>too</i> and <i>enough</i> • make suggestions and recommendations
11	Decisions 72–77	Decision-making	First and second conditionals	How to use <i>if</i>	Negotiating	The Decision Game	• talk about decision-making • talk about future possibilities • use <i>if</i> in different ways • negotiate an agreement
12	Innovation 78–83	Innovation	Superlative forms	How to praise and thank people	Presenting new ideas	Music to your online ears	• talk about innovative ideas • talk about extremes • praise and thank people formally and informally • present new ideas
		Viewpoint 4 VIDEO The Falkirk Wheel 84–85					
13	Breakdowns 86–91	Breakdowns and faults	Relative pronouns	How to check someone understands	Discussing and solving problems	A breakdown in public relations	• talk about breakdowns and faults • use relative pronouns • check someone understands • discuss and solve problems
14	Processes 92–97	Processes	Passive forms	How to explain a process	Dealing with questions	Lean coffee	• talk about, describe and explain processes • deal with questions after a presentation
15	Performance 98–103	Personal qualities	Past continuous and past perfect	How to generalize or be specific	Appraising performance and setting objectives	Extroverts, introverts, and ambiverts	• talk about different personal qualities • talk about past events in your life • generalize and be specific • take part in a performance review
		Viewpoint 5 VIDEO Green Appeal 104–105					

Practice files 106–135

Communication activities 136–143

Audio scripts 144–158

Irregular verb list 159



5

Customers

Starting point

- 1 Who are your main customers?
- 2 How does your company keep its customers happy?
- 3 What percentage of your company's business is online?

Working with words | Customer service

- 1 Read this quote. How true is it for your type of business?
'If you make customers unhappy in the physical world, they might each tell six friends. If you make customers unhappy on the Internet, they can each tell 6,000.'
Jeff Bezos, founder of Amazon
- 2 Read about the company, Zappos. What is the best title for this article?
 - a Training staff to care
 - b Delivering happiness
 - c The customer is always right

ZAPPOS:

For many companies, having a call centre means two things: firstly, that you have unhappy customers and secondly that you have the costs of paying staff to deal with customer complaints.

However, Zappos, the online shoes and clothing retailer, has a positive view of its call centre and uses it to build customer loyalty. Its team (see picture) answer around 5,000 calls per day and 1,200 emails per week about its products. New staff receive four-weeks training in how to make customers happy and Zappos staff will do anything to go beyond basic customer expectations:

- One customer was staying at a hotel in Las Vegas. She wanted a pair of shoes but they weren't in stock. So, a Zappos customer service rep found the required shoes in a local shop and hand-delivered them to the woman's hotel room.
- The best man at a wedding arrived with no shoes. The company delivered in time for the wedding – for free.
- One member of the customer service team has the world record for the longest customer care phone call ever: it lasted ten hours and 29 minutes.

Clearly, with 75% repeat orders, customer satisfaction at Zappos is very high.



3 Read the article again. What do these numbers refer to?

5,000 1,200 4 10'29" 75

4 What do you think of the Zappos call centre? Underline the correct words in *italics* and complete the sentences. Then read out and compare your answers.

I *think* / *don't think* it's a good idea because ...

It *could* / *couldn't* work in my company because ...

5 Complete this table with the word forms in the article in 2.

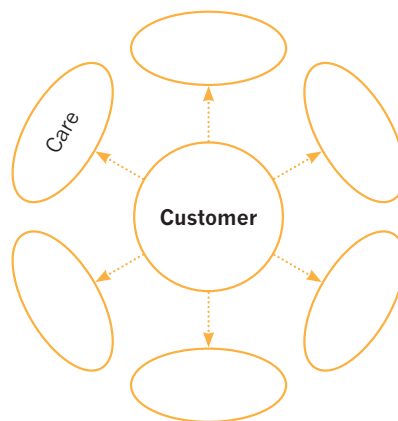
Verb	Adjective	Noun
1 to care	caring	<u>care</u>
2	loyal	_____
3 to expect	expected	_____
4 to require	_____	requirements
5 to serve	_____	_____
6 to satisfy	_____	satisfaction
7 to produce	productive	_____
8 _____	_____	delivery

6 Complete this text with the correct forms of the words from the table in 5.

More than one word is correct for some answers.

Customers always ¹_____ an online company to ²_____ their order on time and in good condition. They are ³_____ if their ⁴_____ are met. However, if there is a problem, it is the role of the customer ⁵_____ department to solve it quickly and efficiently. As a result, if the customer feels that the company really ⁶_____ about them, they become ⁷_____ to the brand.

7 Look at the Zappos text in 2 again. Find different word combinations with the word 'customer' and add them to the mind map below.



Tip | Customer, client, or consumer?

A *customer* is someone who buys a standard product or service.

A *client* is someone who buys an individually designed product or service (e.g. financial advice).

Consumer is a general term to talk about any person who buys things, not a specific product or service.

8 Complete these questions with an appropriate 'customer' collocation from 7.

1 How important is customer _____ in your company?

2 How does your company build customer _____?

3 How does your company deal with customer _____?

4 Do you think it's ever possible to guarantee customer _____?

9 Work with a partner. Ask and answer the questions in 8.

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 5** on page 114.

10 Make five rules and guidelines for successful customer service in your company using words from the table.

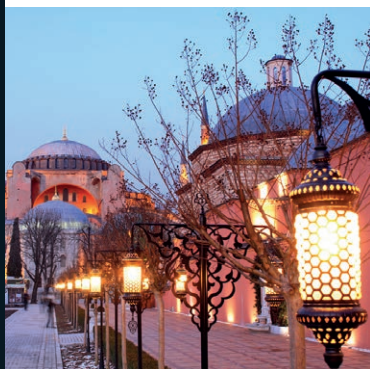
Example: Rule 1: *Don't meet your customer's expectations. Go beyond them.*

Unit 5 | Customers**Language at work** | Present tenses for future reference

- 1 How busy is your schedule this week, next week, and next month? Which are the busiest periods for you/your department/your company?
- 2 Anita and Hakan are planning a series of customer visits in Turkey. Read the schedule and then Anita's email. What changes and additions need to be made to the schedule?

✉	
6 Monday	
5.45–11.45	Flight TK 1988 London – Istanbul.
14.30	Meeting at Aksa
22.00 – 23.05	Flight to Ankara. Meet Giray.
7 Tuesday	
10.00	Leave hotel for meetings from 11.00
19.00	Flight TK 1983 Istanbul – London

✉	
Subject: Next week	
Hi Hakan,	
I'm really sorry but there are changes to the original schedule. We still leave early on Monday and come back on Tuesday, but the bad news is that on Monday we're not meeting the people at Aksa until five – I'm afraid they're busy until then. Anyway, I hope to arrange another visit so we aren't waiting around all afternoon. Other than that, everything is fine for the rest of the trip. By the way, our new agent in Ankara is joining us at 10.00 for the customer visits on Tuesday. His name is Giray Demir.	
Anita	



- 3 Do the verbs in **bold** in the email refer to the present or the future? Match the verbs in the email to the explanations in the *Language point*.

LANGUAGE POINT

- 1 We use verbs in the **present simple** such as *arrive, go, start* to talk about a scheduled or timetabled event in the future: _____
- 2 We use verbs in the **present continuous** to talk about an arrangement for the future: _____
- 3 We use the present tense of **verbs** such as *plan, intend, expect* + **to** + **infinitive** to talk about future plans, hopes and expectations: _____
- 4 We use the present tense of **be** + **adjectives** such as *free, available* to talk about future availability: _____

» For more information, go to **Grammar reference** on page 115.

- 4 ► **5.1** Listen to a message from Giray in Anita's voicemail. What additional changes need to be made to the schedule?
- 5 Read Giray's voicemail message. Underline the correct words in *italics* 1–9. Then listen again and check your answers.

Hi, Anita. This is Giray. I'm sorry but I ¹*be / 'm* busy next Monday evening, so I can't meet you personally at the airport. When your flight ²*arrives / is arriving*, a driver will meet you. Let's plan ³*to meet / meeting* in your hotel reception on Tuesday morning at around eight thirty, because we ⁴*meet / are meeting* the first client at nine thirty instead of eleven. By the way, do you intend ⁵*checking / to check* out in the morning or ⁶*do you stay / are you staying* another night in Ankara? I'm afraid I ⁷*'m not / don't* free in the evening, but I can book you an excellent restaurant near the hotel for dinner if you ⁸*stay / are staying*. It ⁹*opens / is opening* around eight, I think. Anyway, let me know your plans.

Tip | State verbs

Verbs used to talk about states (e.g. *understand, know, like, mean, need*) are not usually used in the present continuous.

6 Look at the schedule below and make sentences using the prompts 1–9.

Example: *I'm going to a conference next week.*

The conference starts on Tuesday.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1 go / conference / next week | 6 free / Thursday morning |
| 2 conference / start | 7 plan / have lunch |
| 3 not / go / first session. / busy | 8 fly / Paris |
| 4 give / my presentation | 9 flight / leave |
| 5 hope / go / buffet reception | |

May		a.m.	p.m.
7	Tuesday	CONFERENCE	
		9.30 First session / Meet clients	
8	Wednesday	CONFERENCE	
			14.00–15.00 My presentation 18.00 End-of-conference buffet reception
9	Thursday	CONFERENCE	
		Free morning	12.30 Lunch with Sally and Remi
10	Friday		To Paris 14.20 Flight from LHR

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 5** on page 115.

7 Tell your partner about your schedule for next week. Talk about when:

- scheduled events start and end
- you plan or hope to do something
- you are available or busy
- you are meeting people or have an arrangement

Practically speaking | How to say 'sorry'

1 Think of a situation when you had to say 'sorry' at work. Who was it to? Why?

2 ▶ **5.2** Listen to sentences 1–5 and match them to reasons a–e.

- | | |
|--|----------------------------|
| 1 I'm sorry, but I'm busy next Monday evening. <u>b</u> | a You did something wrong. |
| 2 I'm sorry, but can you repeat that? ____ | b You can't do something. |
| 3 I'm sorry to keep you waiting. ____ | c You give a reason. |
| 4 I'm sorry, but the traffic was terrible this morning. ____ | d You interrupt someone. |
| 5 I'm sorry, but can I say something at this point? ____ | e You ask for repetition. |

3 ▶ **5.3** Match the responses a–e to sentences 1–5 in 2. Then listen and check.

- a **Sure.** It's A as in Alpha. ____
- b **Of course.** Go ahead. ____
- c **Not to worry.** We haven't started yet. ____
- d **That's OK.** There was a problem with my train as well. ____
- e **No problem.** How about Tuesday instead? ____

4 Work with a partner. Practise each situation by saying sorry to your partner and responding.

- You can't get to work because of a train strike. Call your partner from the train station and explain.
- You can't attend your partner's presentation next week. Give a reason.
- Your partner is a visitor waiting for you in reception. After 15 minutes, you arrive.
- Your partner is explaining something but you didn't hear all the information.

Unit 5 | Customers**Business communication** | Making and changing arrangements

- 1** Who are your company's main suppliers? What do they supply you with?
- 2** ▶ **5.4** Elena Schenker works for a chain of hotels in Switzerland. She calls Sergio Boccherini, a supplier of gym equipment. Listen to their conversation and write E (Elena), S (Sergio), or B (Both) next to each sentence.

- 1 ___ was at a trade show in Geneva last month.
- 2 ___ is based in Bern.
- 3 ___ has clients in Geneva.
- 4 ___ is always busy on Mondays.
- 5 ___ can meet on Tuesday 1st at 3 p.m.

- 3** ▶ **5.4** Read expressions 1–8 for making arrangements. Try to say each expression in a different way, using the words given in brackets. Then listen again and check your answers.

- 1 Can we fix a date to meet? (arrange) Can we arrange a date to meet?
- 2 I'm sorry but I can't on Monday. (afraid I'm busy) _____
- 3 I'm not free on that day. (can't make it) _____
- 4 What about Tuesday? (How) _____
- 5 That's good for me. (suits) _____
- 6 Is two o'clock OK? (convenient) _____
- 7 Can we meet later? (make it) _____
- 8 We've confirmed Tuesday the first at three. (So that's) _____

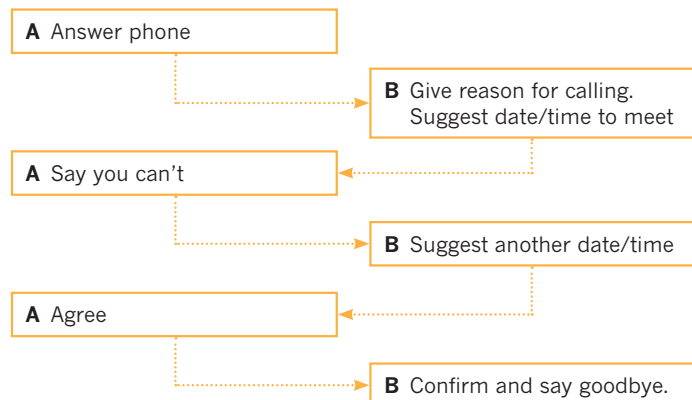
» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 5** on page 114.

- 4** ▶ **5.5** Listen to these short expressions from the conversation for suggesting and checking days, dates and times. Note if the intonation is rising or falling. Then listen again and repeat.

On Monday? The 1st? At three?

- 5** Work with a partner. Take turns to answer the phone and make arrangements for the situations below. Use this flow chart and your own diaries if you want.

- meeting a new customer
- visiting the new company headquarters
- playing golf or tennis
- meeting a colleague to plan a product launch



- 6** ▶ **5.6** Sergio calls Elena again. Listen to their conversation.

- 1 What is the main reason for his call?
- 2 What can't Sergio make?
- 3 Do they bring the meeting forward or move it back a day?

- 7** Repeat your calls in **5** but now you can't make the appointments. Change the arrangements to a new time. Use your own diaries if you want.

Key expressions**Calling to make an arrangement**

The reason I'm calling is ...
I'm calling to arrange ...
It's about our meeting next ...

Suggesting times/dates

Can we arrange a meeting?
Can we fix a date to meet?
What/How about ...?
Is ... convenient/OK?
Is ... any good?
Does ... suit you?

Accepting/Declining

Yes, of course.
That suits me.
That's good/convenient for me.
I'm afraid I can't come on ...
I'm sorry but I can't make it.
I'm not free on ...

Changing arrangements

Can we make it later?
Can we move it back to Friday?
Can we bring it forward to Wednesday?
The afternoon is free/
convenient.

Confirming

So that's Tuesday at three.
We've confirmed Monday at 10 a.m.

TALKING POINT

Upside down management

Timpson is a family business with a £150 million plus turnover. Timpson shops offer a variety of services including shoe repair and key cutting. The secret of the company's success, according to company chairman John Timpson, is to make sure you have 'happy customers' and offer 'great jobs'. To achieve this, the company uses an organizational system called 'upside down management'.

'Upside down management' means that the customers are always at the top and senior management are at the bottom. The role of the managers is to support the frontline staff in the middle, who can then serve the customers. This organogram shows how Timpson works with some of its key principles at each level.

Customers

- They come first.
- Make them smile.
- Happy customers will advertise your company, so don't spend money on marketing.

Frontline Staff

- Charge customers whatever you like. The price list is only a guide.
- Try new ideas. If they work, tell management. If they don't work, just stop.
- Staff can use one of the company's five holiday homes.
- High-performing staff can receive a weekly 15% bonus.
- You always get an extra day off on your birthday!

Management

- Serve your frontline staff. Don't give them orders.
- Praise frontline staff ten times more than you criticize.
- Avoid meetings. They waste time.
- Get rid of poor-performing staff quickly.

Discussion

- 1 Why do you think 'upside down management' has been successful at Timpson?
- 2 Discuss each of the key principles in each level. Which principles does your company have? Which other principles do you agree or disagree with?
- 3 Overall, how well do you think 'upside down management' could work in your company?

Task

- 1 Work in groups of four. Imagine your company is thinking of introducing 'upside down management'. Divide your group into two pairs.

Pair A: Write a list of arguments *for* introducing 'upside down management' and why you think it *will* work in your company.

Pair B: Write a list of arguments *against* introducing 'upside down management' and why you think it *won't* work in your company.

- 2 When you are ready, work with the other pair again. Take turns to present your arguments for and against and discuss both sides of the arguments. Try to reach a final agreement and choose one of the decisions:

- A The company should introduce 'upside down management'.
- B The company should use some (but not all) of the ideas from 'upside down management'.
- C The company should not change the current system of management.

- 3 Present your final decision to the rest of the class and give your reasons.

Viewpoint 2 | Cultural communication

Preview

In this video lesson, you will watch an interview with Michael Dickmann, an expert in cultural awareness in business. He describes how cultural differences in communication can affect business between people of different nationalities and also within different company cultures.

Focus

- 1** When you travel abroad, what is one of the first differences you tend to notice? What differences do you notice when you are in a new country for a long time? Talk about any of the items below or choose a new one.

- architecture
- language
- attitudes to time
- gestures and body language
- people's beliefs
- food and meals
- clothes
- attitude to management
- social behaviour
- relationships between colleagues and clients

- 2**  **01** Watch two people talking about working in other countries. What differences do they talk about? Make notes about their answers in the table.

Speaker 1	
Speaker 2	

- 3** Work with a partner and compare your answers in **2**. Did the people in the video describe any similar differences to you?

Culture in business

- 4** You are going to watch an interview with Michael Dickmann, an expert in cultural differences in business. Before you watch, match the words and phrases 1–8 to the correct definitions a–h.

- 1 mediocre ____
- 2 ethics and values ____
- 3 disciplined ____
- 4 power distance ____
- 5 bribes ____
- 6 behaviour ____
- 7 norms ____
- 8 save face ____

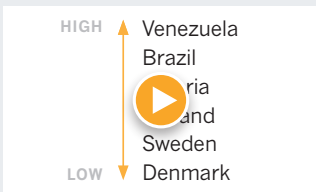
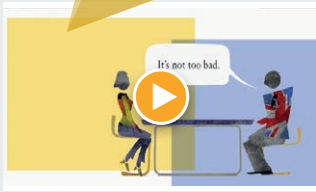
- a your actions in particular situations
- b your beliefs about what is right or wrong which affect your behaviour
- c average, not very good
- d behaving in a very controlled way
- e money you offer in a dishonest way to make someone do something for you
- f the accepted way of doing things in a society or culture
- g an expression meaning to avoid humiliation or not being told you are wrong in front of other people
- h a term to refer to the relationship between people in power and the people who take orders, e.g. between management and workers.

- 5**  **02** Watch the interview with Michael Dickmann. He talks about four areas of cultural difference in business. As you watch, number the areas A–D in the correct order 1–4.

- A The hamburger approach ____
- B Language in business ____
- C Power distance ____
- D Ethics ____



Watch the video here:
oxelt.gl/2cP6Qbl



Cultural awareness

- 6** **03** Watch Part 1 of the video again and answer questions 1–3
- 1 What might a British person mean if they say, 'It's not too bad'?
 - 2 What might a German person think it means?
 - 3 A Nigerian company might describe giving money to get something as Public Relations. What might a western company call it?
- 7** Discuss these questions as a class for your country or countries.
- 1 If you heard someone say in English 'It's not too bad', what would you think it means?
 - 2 In your country, is giving money to win a business deal considered good public relations or is it a bribe? Is it acceptable or is it wrong?
- 8** **04** Watch Part 2 of the video again and complete sentences 1–4. Use words you hear in the video.
- 1 How polite you are and how _____ you are can affect what people think about you.
 - 2 Some people might think that if you are not punctual then you are not _____.
 - 3 If you come from a _____ power distance culture, then you won't disagree with your boss.
 - 4 If you come from a _____ power distance culture like Denmark and you work in a country like Japan, or Nigeria and you speak up against your boss, that is a big problem.
- 9** Underline the correct words in *italics* to make the sentences true for your company. Then, compare your choices with the rest of the class and give reasons for your answers.
- 1 In my company, *it's OK* / *it isn't OK* to disagree with the views of your boss.
 - 2 Overall, I think I come from a country with *high* / *low* power distance.
- 10** **05** Watch Part 3 of the video again and answer questions 1–4.
- 1 In what way is performance management similar to a hamburger bun?
 - 2 If you make a mistake in the USA, how will your manager comment on your work?
 - 3 Why does the Japanese manager miss out the 'meat'?
 - 4 What does Michael Dickmann suggest the approach of the German manager is?
- 11** If you made a mistake in your company, how would your manager discuss this with you? What kind of 'hamburger approach' would he or she take?

Identifying culture in the workplace

- 12** Work in groups. Read about three different business situations and discuss what problem is happening in each situation and why.
- 1   An Italian business person and a Japanese business person are making small talk with each other. Afterwards, the Italian comments that, 'She seemed nice but she never really said anything'. The Japanese says, 'She was very friendly, but she never gave me a chance to speak.'
 - 2   A Belgian manager is working in Thailand. He is unhappy because his Thai assistant is often late for work (between 30 minutes to an hour sometimes). One day he tells her off in front of other employees. She resigns soon after.
 - 3   An American business person is in a meeting with a group of German colleagues. The discussion is very heated and the American feels uncomfortable. Afterwards, he's surprised that everyone decides to go and have a friendly drink together before they go home.
- 13** Now read the explanations on page 137 and compare them with your own.

Business English you can take to work *today*



Student's Book with Online Practice



Teacher's Book & DVD



Class Audio CD

Starter

Student's Book with Online Practice	9780194738569
Teacher's Book	9780194738613
Class Audio CD	9780194738644

Intermediate

Student's Book with Online Practice	9780194738866
Teacher's Book	9780194738910
Class Audio CD	9780194738941

Elementary

Student's Book with Online Practice	9780194738668
Teacher's Book	9780194738712
Class Audio CD	9780194738743

Upper-intermediate

Student's Book with Online Practice	9780194738965
Teacher's Book	9780194739016
Class Audio CD	9780194739047

Pre-intermediate

Student's Book with Online Practice	9780194738767
Teacher's Book	9780194738811
Class Audio CD	9780194738842

Advanced

Student's Book with Online Practice	9780194739061
Teacher's Book	9780194739115
Class Audio CD	9780194739146



Oxford English Vocabulary Trainer app
Your personal English tutor

Practise and review *Business Result Second Edition* vocabulary and get instant, intelligent feedback.

